

Sunday, July 31

We were out of bed by 7:00. After some talk we walked on Mount Royal, just up from Michael's. The road was steep and by the time we got to the top on Hillcrest road Peter was tired. Since I was carrying Matthew on a backpack (listening to his "Hi dada"), Peter was hoisted by Michael. We noted the fastidious gardening, the low-lying willow-swept white bungalows, and the silence. Is life like that? Michael is looking at another apartment nearby, according to him the oldest in Western Canada. Cheryl and I played Risk with Michael as Peter slept. Matthew thumped around to get attention. Cheryl eventually had a nap with Matthew. Peter woke and we played in the park.

We drove to the University after buying huge cones from "My Favourite Ice-cream Place" and sharing opinions about the four 'Valley girls' and their boys. We listened to a folk singer out front for a while, then went to the Chevron building where Michael works. He got visitor passes for the electronic gates. We took the elevator to the 20th floor where both Michael's and Cathy have offices. Cathy's view is the red brick of a building six feet away. Michael is in a corner office with a view of the south and the mountains. Exploration maps are pinned on a wall, a helmet covered with stickers hangs on a hat rack. Matthew gets in his files, and Peter sits at his chair. What more could one ask for in an office in the 1980s. We spent a few minutes in the 24th floor fitness room checking out the training equipment and taking in the view. The boys romped. Back at Michael's, Peter, Matthew and I sat on the swings and hanging horses in the park. Matthew must swing hard. If it slows, he pulls at the chain. Once down, he follows on Peter's heels. After spaghetti and meat-sauce and some conversation, Michael and Cathy go swimming, and Peter and Matthew bathe and go to bed.